

2026 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP PROBLEM SOLVING U12 CANBERRA

NAME: _____

DATE OF BIRTH: _____

Please circle your age group:

- U8 (born in 2019 or after)
- U10 (born in 2017 or after)
- U12 (born in 2015 or after)

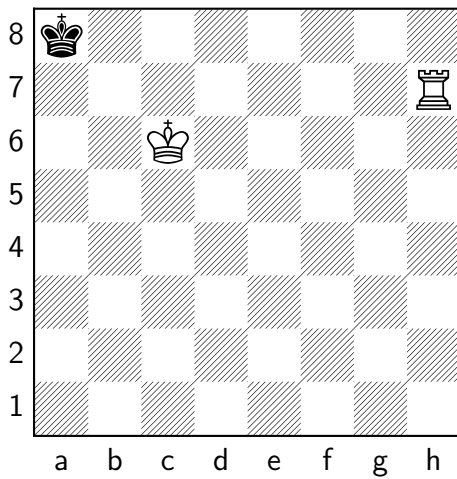
Please circle: Boy or Girl

Please read the following rules.

- You have up to 2 hours for the problem solving paper. You may not need all that time. You can leave after handing in your answers.
- The questions go from easy to hard, so it's best to start at the beginning and go in order.
- You can use your chess board and pieces to help you.
- Each page show a question and a point you can obtain. Please write your answers in the space under each picture. Altogether, the test has 100 points. Even if you don't give perfect answers, you can still get some partial points.
- For endgame puzzles, show enough moves to reach a position where you are clearly winning or drawing.
- You don't have to finish them all, do your best and solve as many puzzles as you can.

Enjoy the problem solving.

Example Q1. Mate in two.

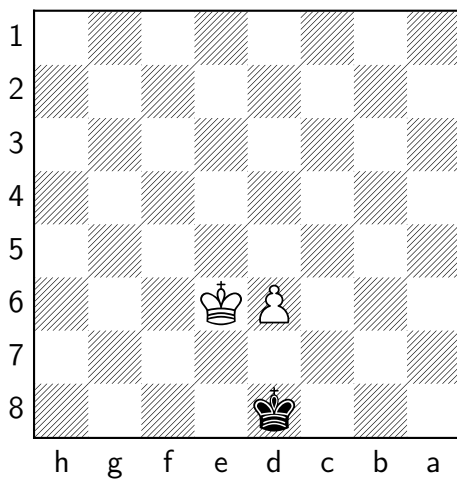


□ The open box shows White's move.

Answer:

1. Kb6 Kb8 ← Write the first White move, then the first Black move.
2. Rh8# (1-0) ← Write the second White move, which is a mate.

Example Q2. Black moves and draws.

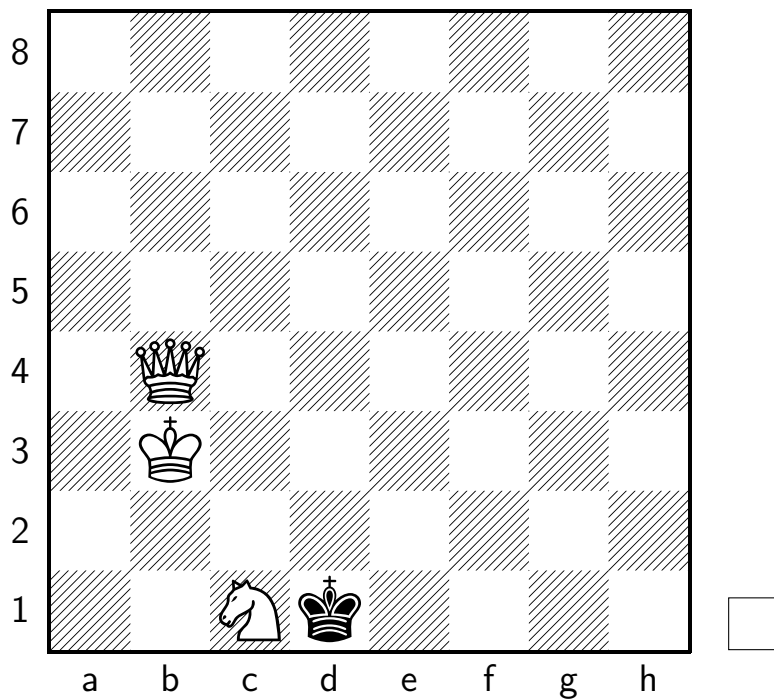


■ The closed box shows Black's move.

Answer:

1. ... Ke8
2. d7+ Kd8
3. Kd6 (draw) ← Write enough moves showing a clear draw position.

Q1. Mate in 2. (4 marks)



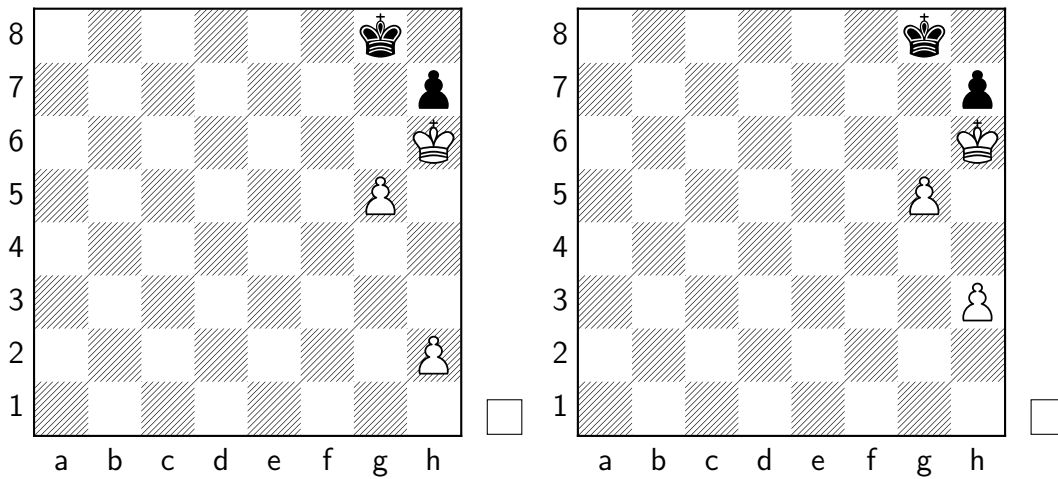
Answer:

1 ♔a5 ♔xc1

2 ♚e1#

Source: 9 Authors Deutsche Schachzeitung, 1968 (YACDB: 82713)

Q2. Is there any difference between left and right?



Answer:

White wins in left and draws in right.

White wins as follow.

1 h3 ♔h8

2 h4 ♔g8

3 h5 ♔h8

4 g6 h×g6

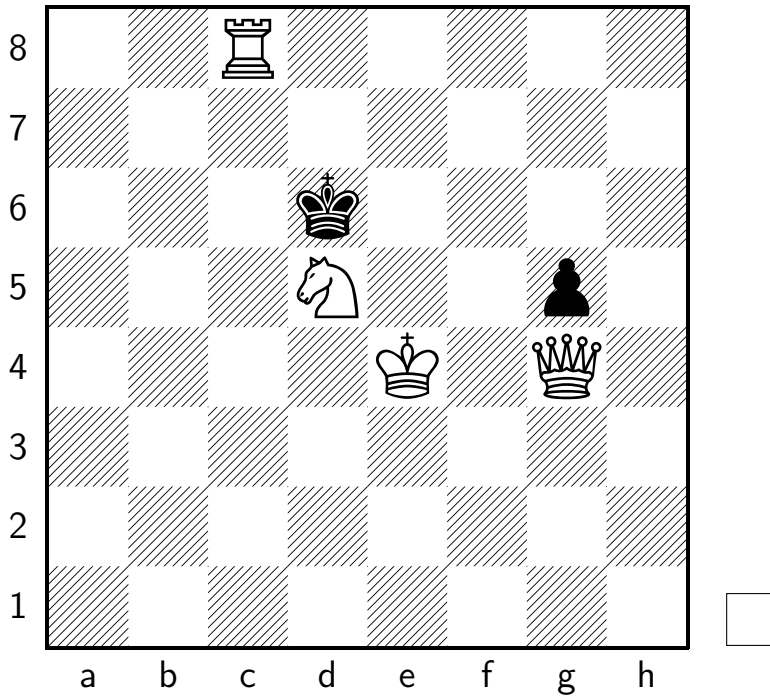
5 h×g6 ♔g8

6 g7

1 h3 ♔h8 **2** h4 ♔g8 **3** h5 ♔h8 **4** g6 h×g6 **5** h×g6 ♔g8 **6** g7

Source: Theoretical endgame

Q3. Mate in 2.



Answer:

1 ♔f5 ♔d7

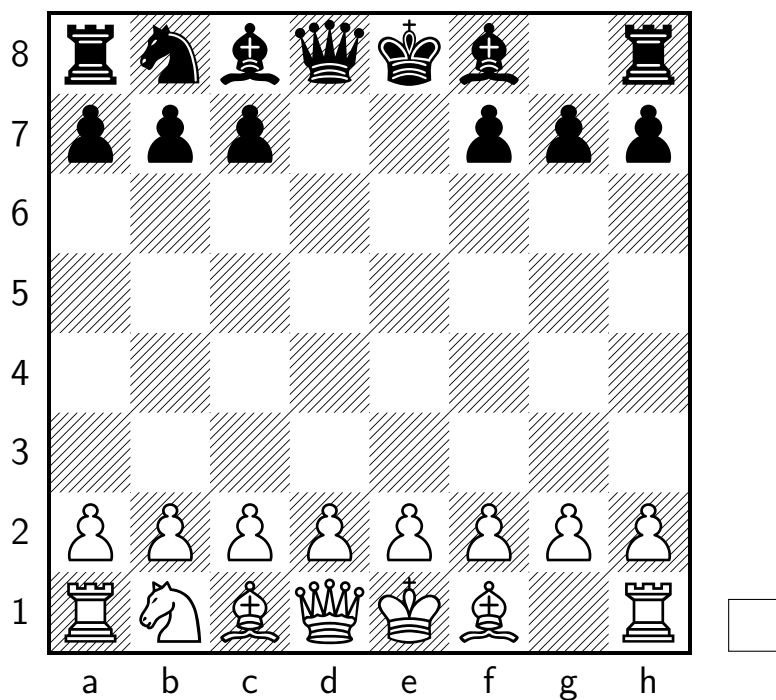
2 ♔e7#

1... ♔xd5

2 ♕d1#

Source: Samuel Loyd, Buffalo Commercial Advertiser, 1879 (YACDB: 32755)

Q5. The position below occurred at the 4th Black's move from the starting position. Answer the moves.



Answer:

1 ♖f6 e5

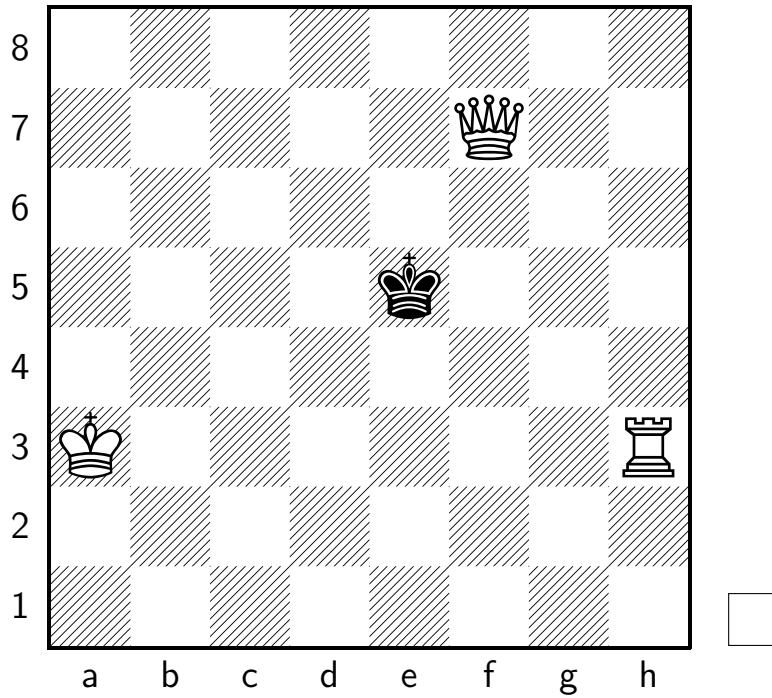
2 ♖xe5 ♖e7

3 ♖xd7 ♖c3

4 ♖xb1 ♖xb1

Source: Ernest Clement Mortimer (version by Andrey Frolkin) Die Schwalbe, 1981

Q6. Mate in 3.



Answer:

1 ♔b4 ♕d6

2 ♖h5 ♔c6

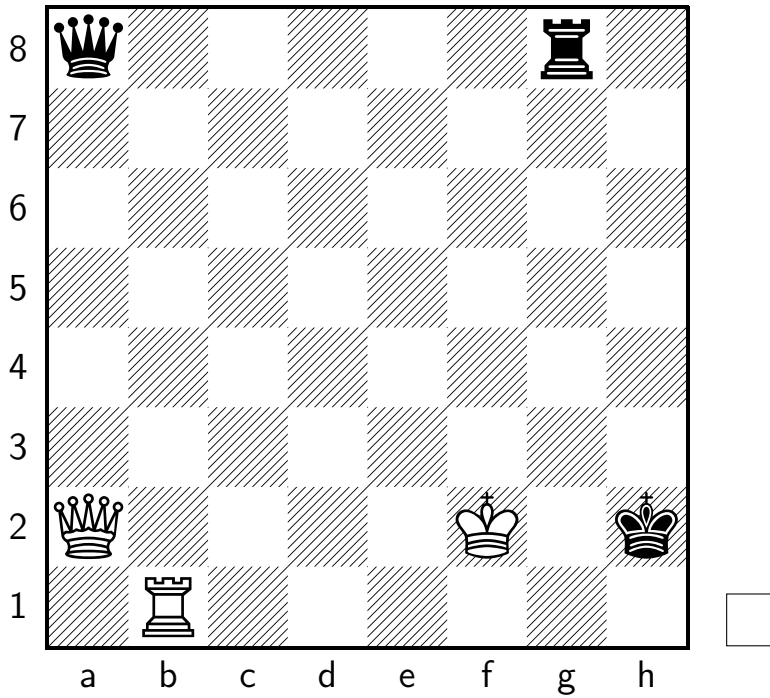
3 ♖h6#

If 1... ♕d4, 2 ♖e8 ♔d5 3 ♖d3#

If 1... ♕e4, 2 ♔c5 ♕e5 3 ♖e3#

Source: Frederick Baird, 1905 (YACDB: 105882)

Q7. Show a winning sequence.



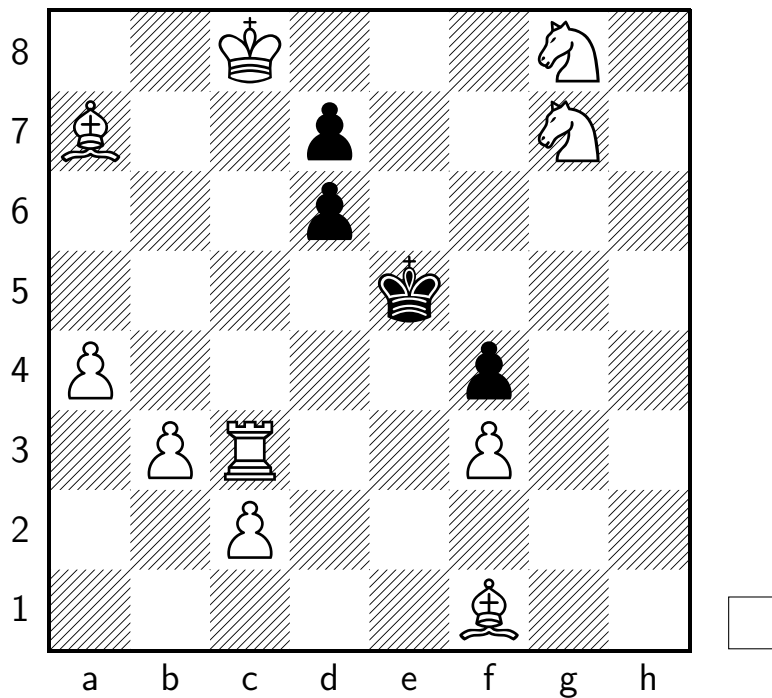
Answer:

1 ♖h1+! ♔×h1 2 ♕×g3
 1 ♖h1+! ♔×h1 2 ♕b1+ ♖g1 3 ♕h7#

Intention: Sacrifice (Easy?)

Source:

Q8. Mate in three.



Answer:

1 ♖g2! ♔d5 2 ♜e3 fxe3 3 f4#

1 ♖g2! ♔d5 2 ♜e3 ♕c6 3 ♘e7#

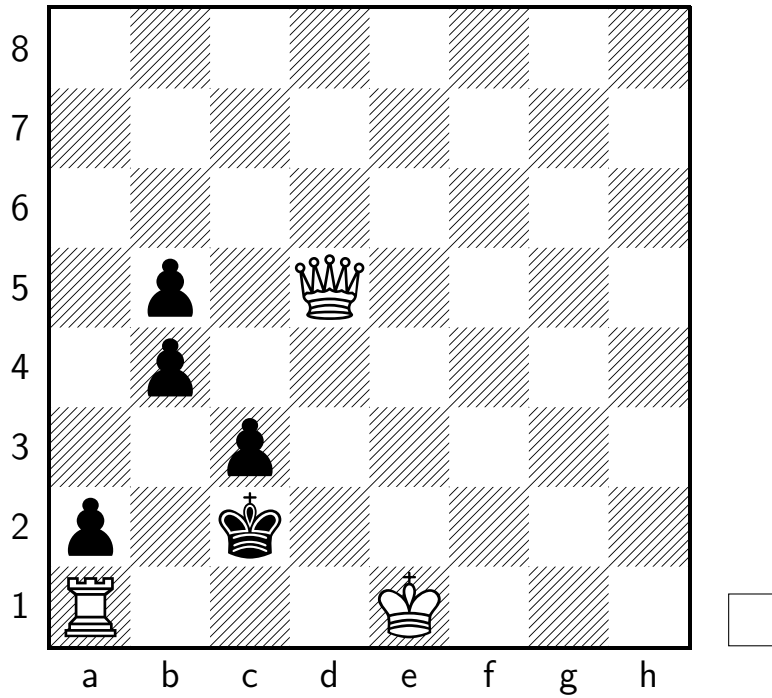
1 ♖g2! d5 2 ♕xd7 d4 3 ♜c5#

1 ♕d7 d5 2 ♜d3+ ♕e5 3 ♕c6 d5 4 ♜d5# (takes 4 moves)

Intention: Counterintuitive 1st move (Medium?)

Source: Thomas Denton Clarke, The Brisbane Courier 1918

Q9. Mate in two.



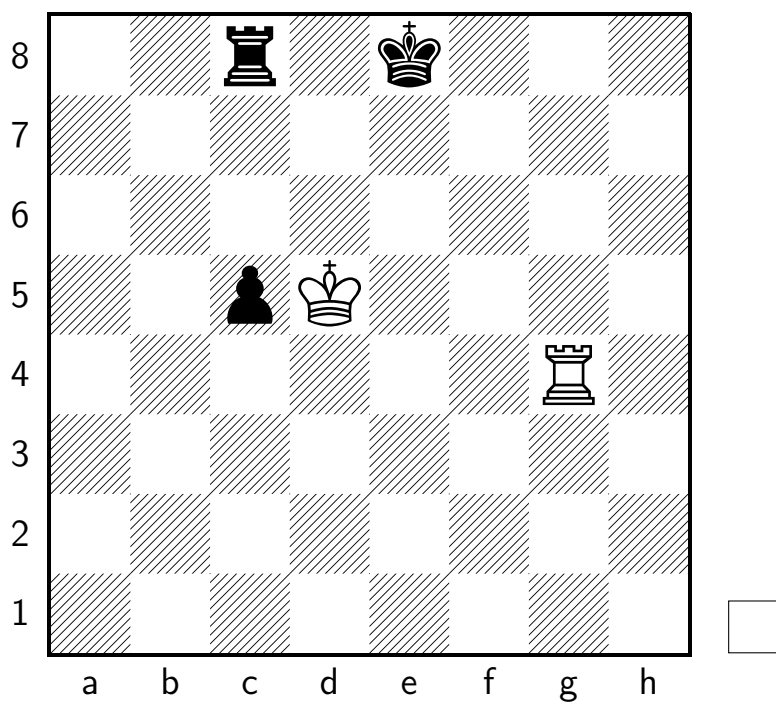
Answer:

1 ♔e6! ♚d3 2 O-O-O#(1-0)(1-0)

Intention: Waiting move, castling (Medium?)

Source: William Whyatt

Study 2. White to play and draw.

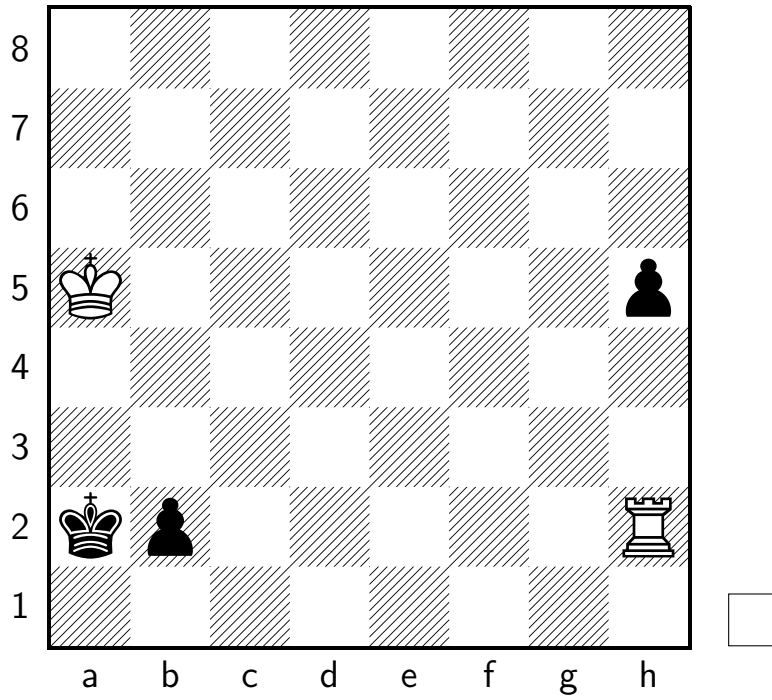


Answer:

1 ♖g8+ ♔d7 2 ♖g7+ ♔e8 3 ♜h7! c4 4 ♔d6! ♜d8 5 ♔e6

Source: Alexey Studenetsky, Shakhmaty v SSSR, 1939

Q10. White to play and draw.

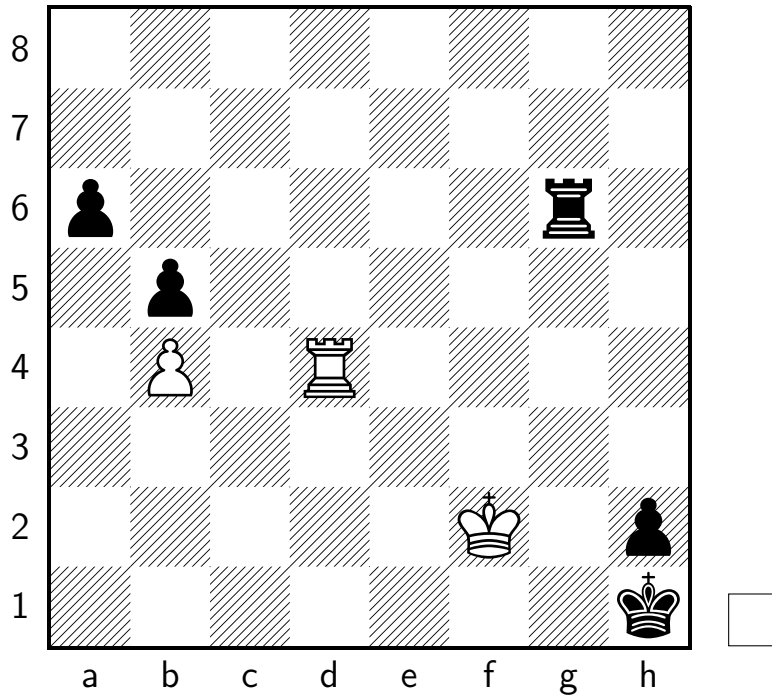


Answer:

1 ♔a6!

Source:

Q11. White to play and win.

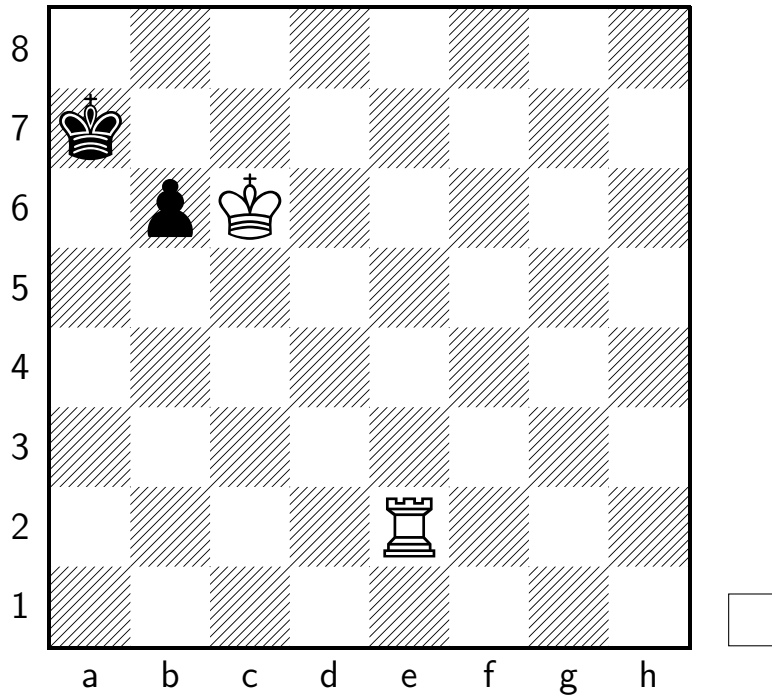


Answer:

1 ♖d1+ ♜g1 2 ♖f1! ♜xf1+ 3 ♔xf1 a5 4 bxa5 b4
5 a6 b3 6 a7 b2 7 a8♚#

Source:

Q12. White to play and mate in 3.

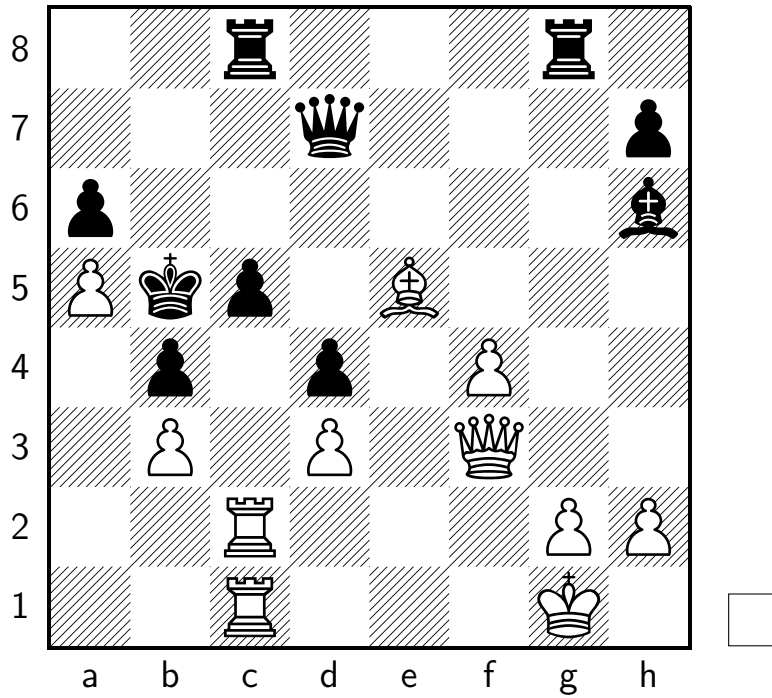


Answer:

1 ♖c2 b5 2 ♕c7 b4 3 ♖a2#

Source:

Q13. White to play and win.

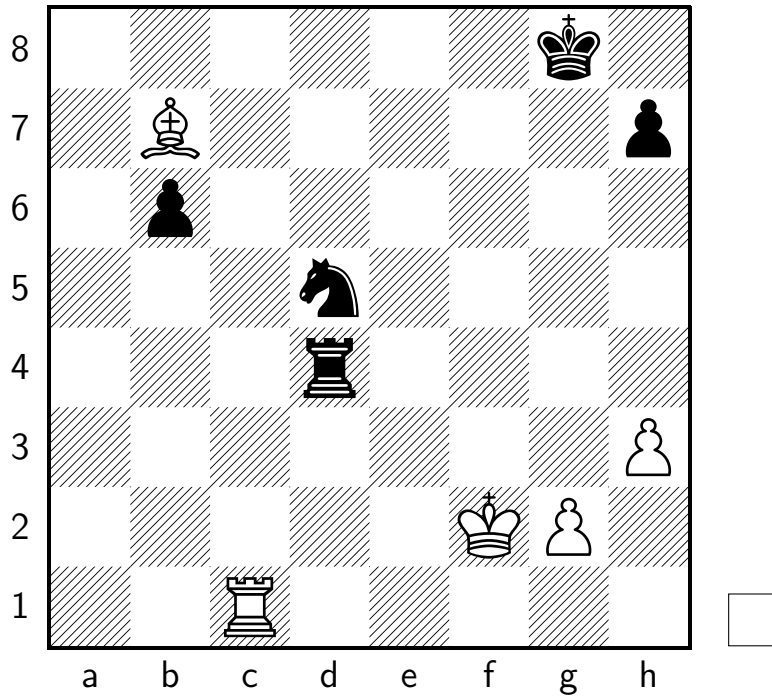


Answer:

1 ♖c7! ♔xc7 2 ♜xc5+ ♕xc5 3 ♖xb7+ ♖b6 4 ♖xb6#
 1 ♖c7! ♜xc7 2 ♖b7+! ♜xb7 3 ♜xc5#

Source:

Q14. White to play and win.

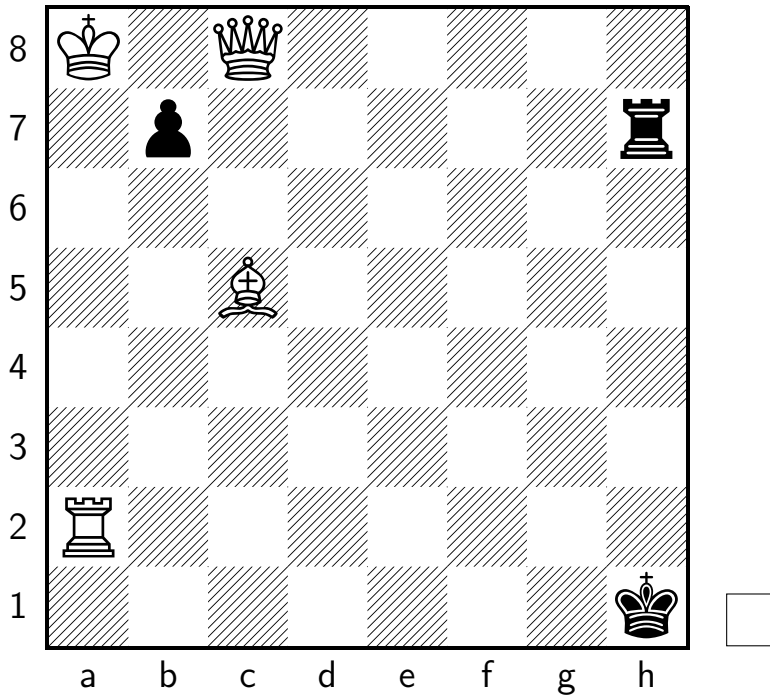


Answer:

1 ♖c4

Source:

Q13. Mate in two.



Answer:

There are three threats, Qc1, Qh3, Qh8.

1 ♖d4 ♜d7 2 ♚c1#

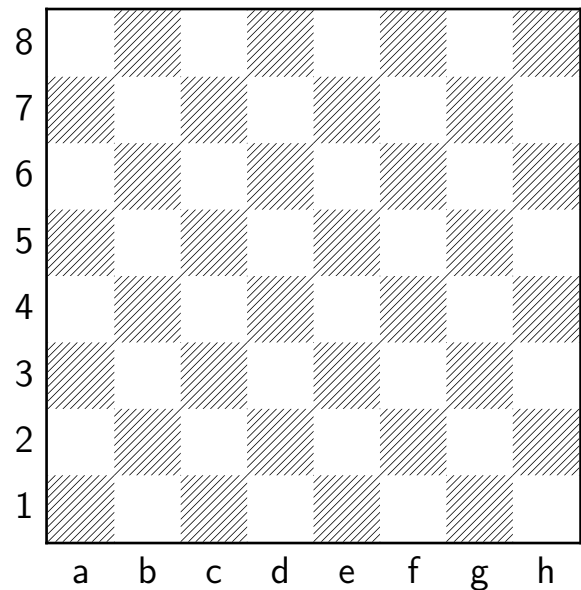
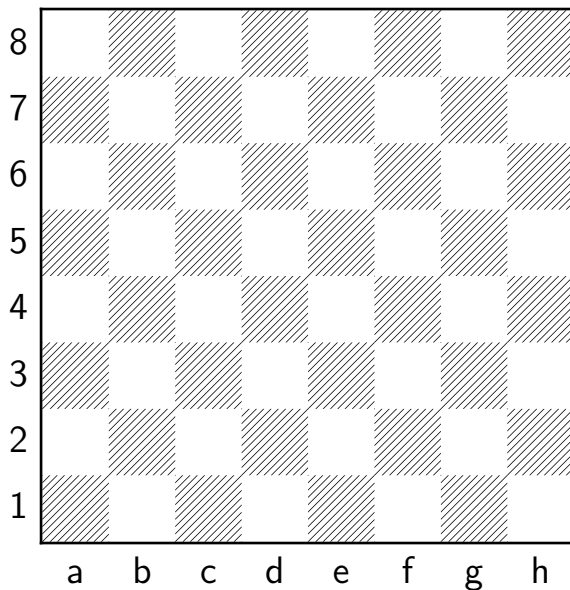
1... ♜c7 2 ♚h3#

Intention:

Source: Miroslav Subotić, The Problemist, 1992 (YACDB: 13286)

Q14. 5 Queens Domination puzzle. Place 5 queens on the board so that all the squares are attacked by those 5 queens. (8 marks)

Do you know? There are 7,624,512 (${}_{64}C_5$) patterns to place 5 queens on the board. Among those pattern, 4,860 patterns are correct. In one episode of "Take Take Take" YouTube channel, Magnus Carlsen took about 5 minutes to complete this task. Can you beat him?

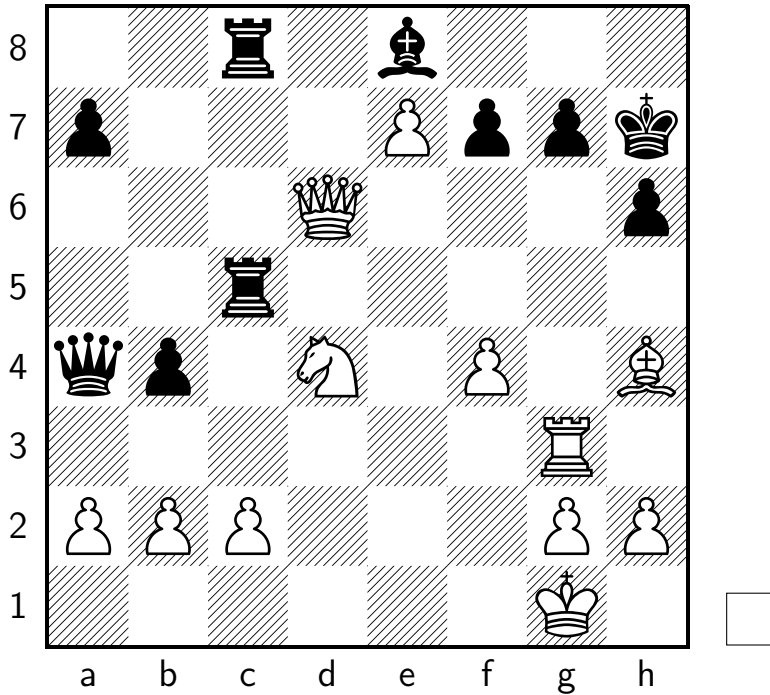


Answer:

Fill 5 squares in the left board with the letters "Q". When you make mistakes in the left board, put a large cross on the left board and use the right board.

Q15. Mate in eight. (8 marks)

In memory of Daniel Naroditsky (1995-2025). He is an American grand master, and he is famous streamer as "Danya". He tragically passed away in October 2025 at the age of 29.



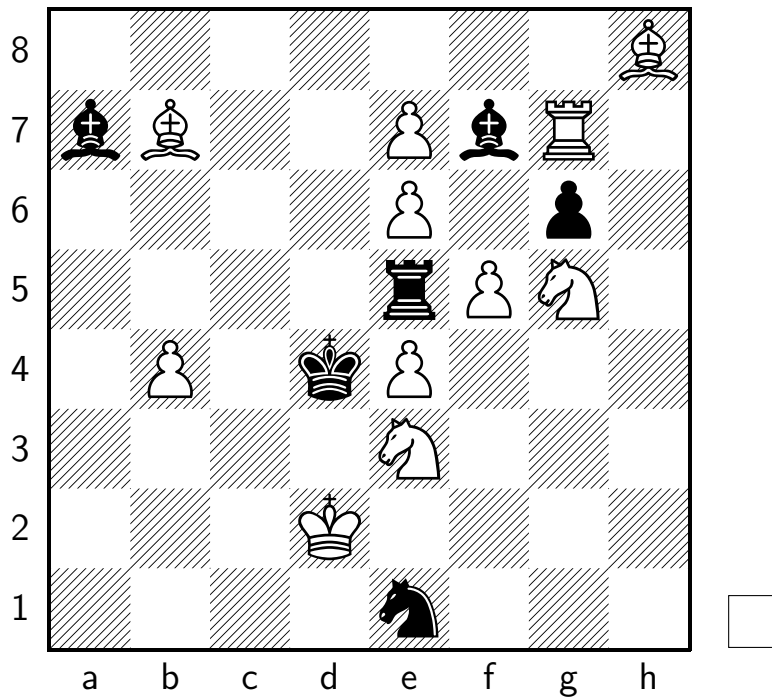
Answer:

1 ♖xg7+! ♔xg7 2 ♕f6+ ♔g8 3 ♞e6 fxe6 4 ♕f8+ ♔h7 5 ♘f6 ♖g5 6 f×g5 ♔g6 7 g4 ♕xc3 8 ♕g7#

Intention: Might be long, but straightforward (Medium?)

Source: Daniel Naroditsky - Timur Gareyev 2020

Q. Mate in 3.



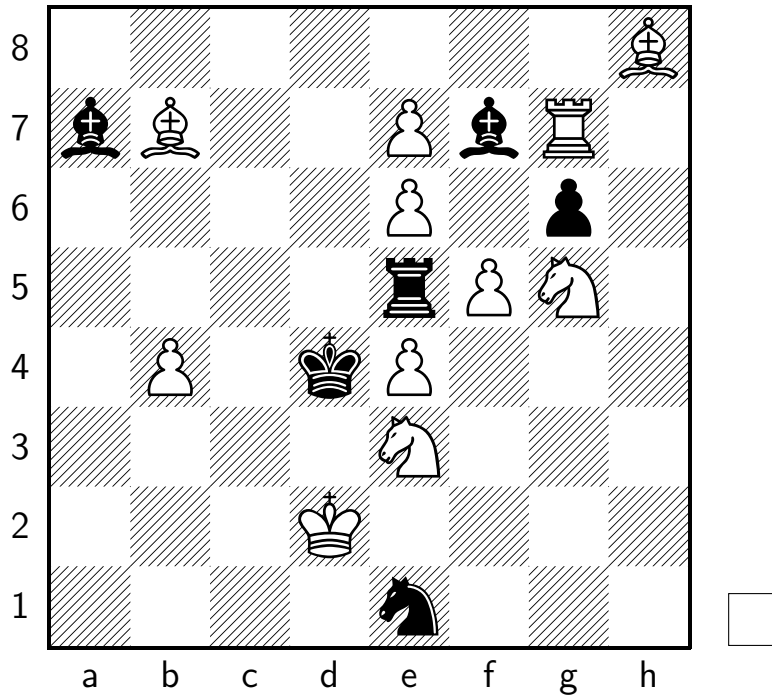
Answer:

1 ♖d5!

Any moves except e5 Rook, **2 ♜c2+ ♜xc2** **3 ♜f3#**.

Source: Valentin Fedorovich Rudenko, Problemnoter, 1960 (YACDB: 57240)

Q. Mate in 3.



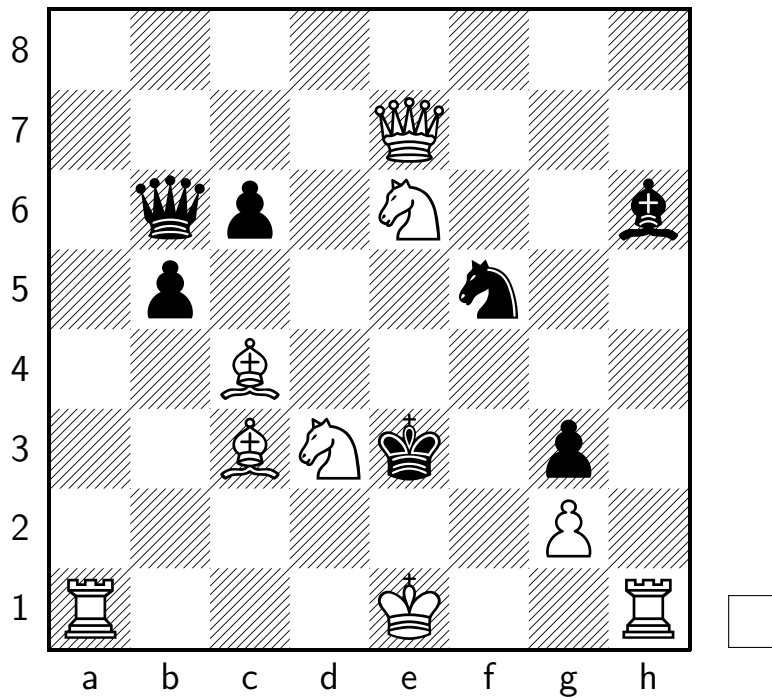
Answer:

1 ♔d5!

Any moves except e5 Rook, 2 ♘c2+ ♘xc2 3 ♘f3#.

Source: Valentin Fedorovich Rudenko, Problemnoter, 1960 (YACDB: 57240)

Q. Mate in 3.

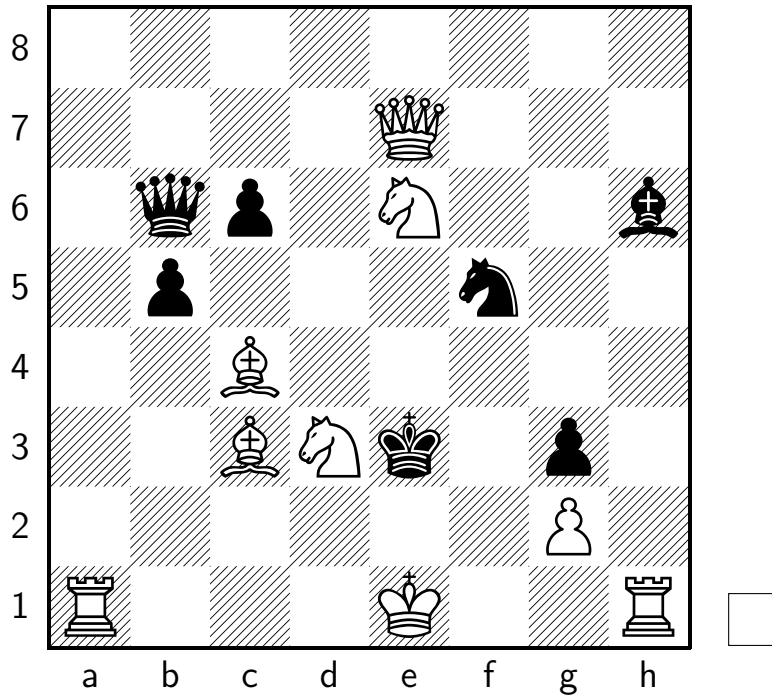


Answer:

1 O-O-O

Source: Michael Lipton, Great Britain - Israel, 1961 (YACDB: 36663)

Q. Mate in 2.

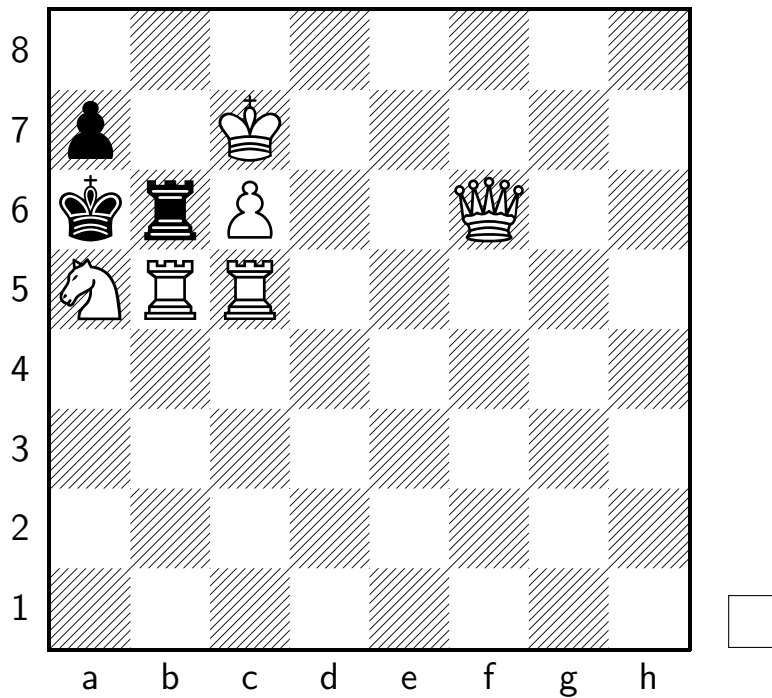


Answer:

1 O-O-O

Source: Michael Lipton, Great Britain - Israel, 1961 (YACDB: 36663)

Q. Mate in 2.



Answer:

1 ♔f1

Source: Cornelis Goldschmeding, problem (Zagreb), 1957 (YACDB: 8721)
32371 Mansfield, Comins La Settimana Enigmistica, 1935 2nd Prize, Categoria I, 1st half-year La Settimana Enigmistica, 1935
32806 Morse, Christopher Jeremy The Observer, 1962